CITY OF WESTMINSTER

MINUTES OF PROCEEDINGS

At the Meeting of the Council of the City of Westminster held at 7.00 pm on Wednesday 12th November, 2025 at Westminster Council House, 97-113 Marylebone Road, London, NW1 5PT.

PRESENT

The Lord Mayor, Councillor Paul Dimoldenberg

COUNCILLORS

Concia Albert
Barbara Arzymanow
Tim Barnes
Liza Begum
David Boothroyd
Ruth Bush
Melvyn Caplan
Maggie Carman
Md Shamsed Chowdhury
Laila Cunningham
Lorraine Dean
Tony Devenish
Robert Eagleton
Paul Fisher
Hannah Galley
Jim Glen
David Harvey
Sara Hassan
Martin Hayes
Elizabeth Hitchcock
Regan Hook
Adam Hug
Louise Hyams
Ryan Jude
Aicha Less
Iman Less
Patrick Lilley
Patricia McAllister
Tim Mitchell
Matt Noble
Ellie Ormsby
Ralu Oteh-Osoka
Angela Piddock
Ed Pitt Ford
Robert Rigby
Rachael Robathan
Ian Rowley
Cara Sanquest
Caroline Sargent
Karen Scarborough
Mark Shearer
Selina Short
James Small-Edwards
Judith Southern
Max Sullivan
Paul Swaddle
Hamza Taouzzale
Aziz Toki
Jacqui Wilkinson
Jason Williams

APOLOGIES: Councillors Geoff Barraclough, Nafsika Butler-Thalassis and Alan Mendoza

The Lord Mayor invited the Council to join him in observing a minute's silence in memory of former Councillor, Harvey Marshall, who had sadly passed away.

1 APPOINTMENT OF RELIEF CHAIR

1.1 Motion moved by the Lord Mayor and seconded by Councillor Iman Less, that Councillor Judith Southern be elected as Relief Chair.

1.2 Motion put, and on a show of hands, declared **CARRIED**.

2 MINUTES

2.1 The minutes of the proceedings at the Council meetings held on Wednesday 10 September 2025 were, with the assent of the Members present, signed by the Lord Mayor as a true record of the proceedings.

3 LORD MAYOR'S COMMUNICATIONS

3.1 The Lord Mayor referred to these as set out in the papers.

4 DECLARATIONS OF INTEREST

4.1 Councillor Ed Pitt Ford declared a disclosable pecuniary interest in relation to Item 9 on the agenda, Councillor Issue. As the item was for information only and no decision was required, the Councillor remained in the meeting to participate in the item.

5 STATEMENT ON URGENT MATTERS

5.1 There were no urgent matters.

6 COUNCILLOR PRESENTED PETITIONS AND DEPUTATIONS, IF ANY

6.1 There were no petitions or deputations received.

7 PUBLIC PARTICIPATION

7.1 Members of the public presented two petitions and asked four questions which were responded to by the relevant Cabinet Members. The petitions, questions and responses would be made available on the Council’s website.

8 QUESTIONS

8.1 The questions, supplementary questions and replies are included as a recording on the Council’s website.

9 COUNCILLOR ISSUE

9.1 **The Importance of Choosing the Right Domestic Heating Systems Within Pimlico and Why this Matters for Current Residents and Generations to Come**

Councillor Ed Pitt Ford spoke, and Councillor Liza Begum replied.

10 PARTY BUSINESS

10.1 The Opposition Party selected to debate the topic of 'Tackling homelessness and rough sleeping in Westminster in the winter of 25-26 and beyond'. The debate would be referred to the relevant Executive Director for consideration when reporting on the subject.

11 REPORT TO FULL COUNCIL: CONSTITUTIONAL UPDATE - LONDON SQUARES PRESERVATION ACT 1931

11.1 The Lord Mayor put the recommendations of the report to the vote and on a show of hands declared the recommendations approved.

RESOLVED:

That Full Council approve:

1) Formal delegation of its functions under the London Squares Preservation Act 1931 and any Local Act requiring decisions relating to planning and building control functions, to the extent that these are non-executive functions, to the Council's Strategic and Planning Sub Committees; and

2) The amendments to the constitution provided in appendix 1 of the report.

12 REPORT TO FULL COUNCIL: PROGRAMME OF MEETINGS 2026/2027

12.1 The Lord Mayor put the recommendations of the report to the vote and on a show of hands declared the recommendations approved.

RESOLVED:

That Full Council approve:

1) The dates of full Council Meetings, as follows: 17 June 2026, 16 September 2026, 11 November 2026, 20 January 2027, 3 March 2027, 12 May 2027 (Annual); and

2) The Programme of other formal Meetings set out in Appendix A of the report.

13 NOTICE OF MOTION

Standing United Against the Rise of the Far Right and in Support of Inclusive Communities

13.1 The Majority Party had selected for debate the notice of motion as set out on the agenda. The notice of motion was moved by Councillor Adam Hug and seconded by Councillor Ryan Jude.

13.2 Following the debate, The Lord Mayor put the motion to the vote and following a show of hands declared the motion **CARRIED**.

RESOLVED:

That

This Council notes:

- The deeply worrying rise in far-right activity, anti-migrant language, and hate incidents across the country, and the impact these have had on our communities here in Westminster.

- Westminster has always been one of the most diverse and welcoming places in the world. People from more than 180 nationalities live here, speaking over 150 languages. Our city's strength comes from that diversity and from the contributions of those who have made Westminster their home to build our shared community.

- From the long-established Irish, Jewish and Caribbean communities in areas like Maida Vale, Harrow Road and Church Street, to newer communities from Bangladesh, Somalia, Morocco and across the Arab world, including Kurdish and Iraqi residents around Edgware Road, Westminster's culture and identity are shaped and enriched by people from every background and part of the world.

- The welcome progress the Council has made in becoming a more diverse and inclusive employer.

This Council believes:

- That migrant and minority communities have increasingly been targeted by divisive and misleading political rhetoric, often used to exploit hardship and drive wedges between people.

- That Westminster, like the rest of the country, faces serious challenges: a cost-of-living crisis, high housing costs, and years of underfunding of public services. But blaming migrants does not solve these problems. It only spreads fear and distracts from the real issues

- That Westminster residents with indefinite leave to remain and settled status make hugely important contributions to our community and our

city. It would be a disgraceful departure from the values of our city to seek to deport our friends and neighbours with ILR or Settled Status if they happen to earn below £38,700 or if they or their dependents (including British citizens) have ever claimed any form of state support or have ever lived in council housing.

- That residents, community groups and faith leaders across Westminster continue to work hard to bring people together and promote understanding.

This Council therefore resolves to:

1. Reaffirm Westminster City Council's unwavering and full commitment to tackling racism and discrimination in all its forms, and to be leading by example to create a more inclusive council and community, building on the 2023 Anti-Racist Organisation and Borough of Sanctuary commitments amongst other policies.

2. Work closely with local partners and communities affected by hate or discrimination to ensure that council support is visible, consistent, and responsive to local needs.

3. Establish a cross-community working group, including residents, community representatives, youth voices, and faith leaders, to share experiences and understanding that develops practical community-led strategies.

4. Champion and promote local initiatives that celebrate Westminster's diversity and bring people together, including cultural festivals, interfaith gatherings, and youth programmes.

5. Condemn unequivocally all forms of racism, xenophobia, Islamophobia, antisemitism, and far-right extremism, and continue to work with the police and community partners to ensure related crimes are tackled swiftly and victims are treated with dignity and respect.

6. Reaffirm Westminster's commitment to remaining a safe, inclusive, and welcoming city where everyone, regardless of background or belief, can feel proud. To this end the council will deliver a new Community Equality Strategy focused on improving council services to ensuring earlier support is given and strengthening its role in promoting community cohesion.

The Meeting ended at 9.39 pm

CHAIR: _____ **DATE:** _____